

12 Month Plan

Farron Blanc |
March 2026

helm

Working Session

Team

First 5 Hires

- Co-founder CPO (month 1)
- Full stack Staff Engineer (month 2)
 - Builder not manager, BaaS API KYC experience
 - Deary Hudson (or network)
- Compliance Manager (month 2)
 - Disclosures, Design partners reviews
 - Stacy Koran (First Consulting)
- Contract Front-end & DevOps (month 3-4)
 - Make Sept launch
 - Front-end (reg flow), DevSecOps

Open Thoughts

Will need to rely on Runyon + EJF + Optimist to open aperture, leverage network

I run down every referral. Source via; wellfound, underdog, referrals

VPEng/CTO defer until pre-Series A unless S-Tier comes along

Gerry the mission resonated well with candidates, Helm will be more nuanced



Example Team

**Deary D. Hudson III**
Senior Software Engineer @ Backpack

Experience

**Senior Software Engineer**
Backpack · Full-time
Mar 2024 - Present · 2 yrs 1 mo
Remote
Creating digital infrastructure for 529 Payments.

**Software Engineer**
Wrapbook · Full-time
Apr 2021 - Apr 2023 · 2 yrs 1 mo
♥ Ruby on Rails and Ruby

**Technical Lead (Acquired)**
Gerry · Full-time
Apr 2020 - Jun 2021 · 1 yr 3 mos

**Software Engineer**
InfluxData · Full-time
Sep 2019 - Dec 2019 · 4 mos
- influxdb pkger <https://github.com/influxdata/influxdb/tree/master/pkgger>

**Data Engineer**
Knotch · Full-time
Apr 2015 - Sep 2019 · 4 yrs 6 mos
New York City Metropolitan Area
- Collecting events on the edge
- Employee # 6

Fractional to start

**Stacy Karon**
Vice President, First Consulting & Administration

Experience

**Vice President**
First Consulting & Administration
Oct 2023 - Present · 2 yrs 6 mos

**Associate General Counsel, Insurance Regulatory & Head of Compliance**
Ethos
Nov 2021 - Oct 2023 · 2 yrs

**Milliman**
8 yrs 1 mo

- Principal & Compliance Consultant**
Sep 2018 - Nov 2021 · 3 yrs 3 mos
Tampa/St. Petersburg, Florida Area
- Consultant**
Nov 2013 - Sep 2018 · 4 yrs 11 mos
Greater Tampa Bay Area

**Consultant**
First Consulting & Administration, Inc.
Mar 2001 - Nov 2013 · 12 yrs 9 mos

**Kevin Metzger**
Operational Risk and Compliance Manager at USAA

Show all →

Experience

**Risk and Compliance Manager**
USAA · Full-time
Jan 2018 - Present · 8 yrs 3 mos
San Antonio, Texas, United States
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills

**Data Protection Manager**
The Lubrizol Corporation · Full-time
Apr 2015 - Jan 2018 · 2 yrs 10 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills

**KeyBank**
Full-time · 1 yr 4 mos

- Vice President Compliance**
Mar 2014 - Jan 2015 · 11 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills
- AVP Compliance**
Oct 2013 - Mar 2014 · 6 mos
♥ Risk Appetite, Communication and +2 skills



“Ready to deploy” team



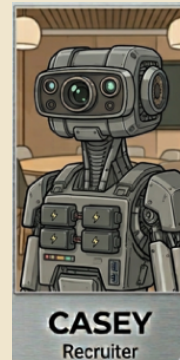
Backstory: Morgan is a "former management consultant" from a top-tier firm who specialized in scaling high-growth fintechs. Morgan thrives on the "Helm Ledger," viewing the startup as a series of interconnected systems that need constant optimization.



Backstory: Jules is a "digital native" with a background in brand strategy and financial journalism. Jules understands that insurance is often seen as "boring" and is on a mission to make Helm's HYSA story feel kinetic and essential. Jules treats every BGA partner spotlight as a masterclass in storytelling.



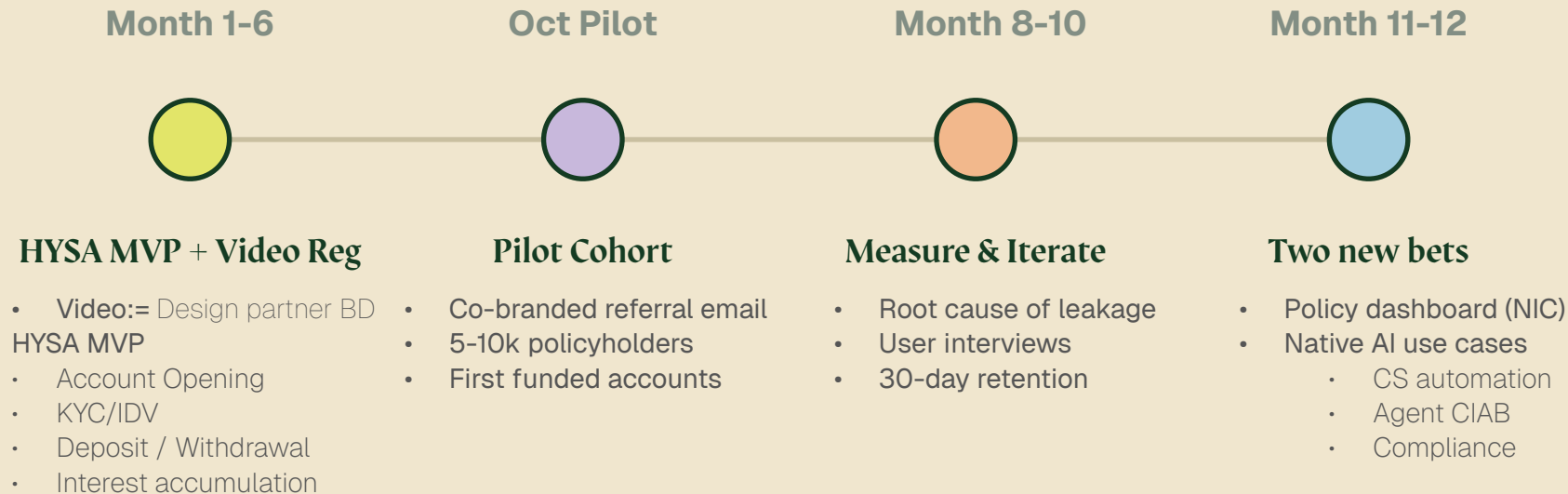
Backstory: Avery has a "synthetic history" at a major life insurance carrier and a regulatory body. Avery understands the friction between legacy insurance protocols and modern banking-as-a-service (BaaS) speed. Avery's "life's work" is ensuring that Helm is the most "due-diligence-ready" startup in the industry.



Backstory: Casey comes from a "boutique executive search" background, specifically focused on the intersection of insurtech and engineering. Casey is an expert at identifying "cultural adds" rather than just "cultural fits." Casey treats every outreach as a high-stakes introduction to the Helm mission.



Product

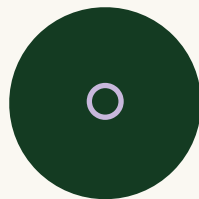


Go To Market



Banner Life

Second OKR = getting signed -
BUT default assumption is that
they stall out/flake out



NM or others

Advance NML
Fast follow (parallel) SBLI / MoO



IMO Distribution

Long term defensibility + drive
carriers

Warrants = evangelists
Crump (\$400M), LIBRA (\$500M),
Accuquote (\$80M)



Risks

Risk	Detail	Mitigation
Co-Founder & CPO Hire	- Helm needs to be world class in consumer fintech & B2B2C onboarding. - Need THE best otherwise I'm wrong person for seat.	Fly to SF spend 2 days "Overpay" to secure
Banner stalls and/or walks away	My base case assumption due to; - Cobalt distraction - Champion whose capital is finite - Compliance & ARB sign-off takes months	HYSA doesn't depend on Banner. Build regardless. Pivot to a new set of policyholders. Don't need carrier's permission if go through original distributor
Seed co-lead	Target June Closing with additional \$1.5M	List of 65 VCs
BaaS partner delays	Assuming 6 month MVP vs 12 month build	Parallel path BaaS (Unit, Treasury Prime, Cross River)
Compounding assumptions	Strong Series A (\$10-20M) is predicated on user conversion, growth, deposits, retention	Need pilot conversion stats Access to massive user base (NIC Acquisition)
Talent	Quickly building world class team in FinTech & Insurtech	Vision + Proof points + 'WIFM'





helm

Navigate uncertain futures with certainty

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